

Clean Code Development: Personal Cheat Sheet

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#	Principle	Definition
1	Single Responsibility	Every function or class has one reason to change. If you say 'and' when describing it, split it.
2	Meaningful Names	Name things what they are. 'commits' beats 'arr'. A good name makes a comment unnecessary.
3	Small Functions	If you cannot read the whole function in one glance, it does too much. Keep it focused.
4	Pure Functions	Depend only on inputs, affect only outputs. No hidden state, no side effects.
5	Fail Fast	Validate at the boundary. Exit early with a clear message. Do not let bad state travel deep.
6	DRY	Do not Repeat Yourself. Duplication means two places to update and one will be forgotten.
7	Comments: WHY not WHAT	Code shows what is happening. Comments explain why a non-obvious decision was made.
8	Consistent Formatting	Use a linter and automate style so you never have to think about it.
9	Early Returns	Guard clauses at the top keep the happy path at the left margin and flatten nesting.
10	No Magic Numbers	Use named constants. <code>SHORT_HASH_LENGTH = 7</code> explains what the value means.
11	One Abstraction Level	Do not mix high-level logic with low-level detail in the same function.
12	Avoid Output Arguments	Do not pass an object in just to mutate it. Return a new value instead.